

EG US Daily: Shaky peace holds after stepped-up strikes

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US Daily

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Shaky peace holds after stepped-up strikes

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 - * Rising ACA costs will be political focus for Democrats
 - * Removal of Syria's terror designation opens path for investment
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Shaky peace holds after stepped-up strikes. The US struck 90 targets along the Iranian coast, continuing to target infrastructure that supports Iranian attacks on shipping—air defenses, radar sites, missile and drone storage sites, and naval capabilities. Iran attacked US targets in the Gulf and Middle East in response, but so far no damage has been reported.

* Intermittent fighting—and strait closure—remains inside our basecase of a shaky peace (60%). Except for a symbolic strike on a railway leading to Mashhad, where Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei will be buried after funeral services conclude, the US has not crossed the Iranian red line of attacking civilian infrastructure, and Iran has not crossed the regional red line of retaliating against energy infrastructure.

* If Iranian strikes on shipping continue the US may see escalation as its only option, triggering a blockade on Iranian ports which in turn would lead to more intense Iranian retaliation, taking us into our 35% scenario of serious escalation. Strikes alone do not lead to this scenario.

* However, we continue to assess that neither side seeks to go down this path and are maintaining our basecase of a shaky peace.

Rising ACA costs will be a political focus for Democrats. Analysis from the Peterson-KFF Health System Tracker finds that insurers in Affordable Care Act marketplaces in 16 states are proposing a median premium increase of 14% for 2027, on top of a 20% rate last year.

* Rising premium costs will be a major political subject for Democrats. While a relatively small proportion of Americans—roughly 22 million—pay for ACA marketplace coverage, Democrats will use the increase in costs to highlight what they will characterize as the Trump administration's poor record on affordability in midterm campaign.

* Roughly 4 million individuals dropped marketplace coverage after ACA subsidies expired last year, according to the KFF analysis . Recently released data shows not all states were affected equally: Oklahoma and Ohio saw the largest proportion of ACA enrollees drop coverage, with 32% fewer ACA enrollees in February 2026 compared to February 2025. Other states that lost more than a quarter of their enrollees included Arizona, South Carolina, Minnesota, Indiana, Michigan, Mississippi, Louisiana and Missouri. Florida saw the largest drop in total enrollees.

* Democrats will likely push for a revival of the ACA subsidies; Democrats' congressional leadership will face immense pressure from the party's base to use government shutdowns and the 2027 debt ceiling battle as a leverage, as they did in 2025 to no avail.

* The White House will respond by emphasizing non-ACA healthcare issues, such as its rhetorical push on insurers to bring down premiums and its efforts to reduce drug prices through voluntary deals and through its TrumpRx scheme. The administration has already moved to expand ACA marketplace eligibility for so-called "catastrophic" plans and to raise out-of-pocket maximums, both moves on which it could expand next year.

Removal of Syria's terror designation opens path for investment. Secretary of State Marco Rubio told reporters yesterday that the State Department had notified Congress of its intention to delist Syria as a State Sponsor of Terrorism (SST).

* Rubio and Trump have long telegraphed their intention to normalize relations with Syria, having laid the groundwork in the President's June 2025 executive order instructing a review of Syria's SST status. The US-Syria relationship gained further momentum with the repeal of the Caesar Sanctions Act last year.

* Under the SST designation firms faced steep delays and administrative hurdles to attain export licenses to Syria, obstacles which decisionmakers in Washington feared would turn Syria toward Beijing. These hurdles will be gone with the designation's removal. That could be a significant upside to the energy and oil sectors, as it will solidify the legal status of pre-existing and future agreements with Syria's state-owned energy company.

* Looking ahead, Syria's estimated reconstruction costs sit at nearly \$216 billion. Gulf States, particularly Saudi Arabia and Qatar, have positioned themselves as leading partners for future reconstruction projects. After the removal of the SST tag, foreign investors now have greatly reduced compliance exposure.

Quote of the Day

"I will say, I did have issues, and I still do. But Spain came back all the way today." – President Trump speaking on Air Force One yesterday, appearing to backtrack on threats to impose an embargo on Spanish goods over concerns about Spain's defense spending. Periodic threats of tariffs or embargos on countries with which Trump has particular bilateral concerns will be a persistent element of the Trump playbook, but follow-through is likely to be limited at best.

On the Radar

13 July: Congress returns from July 4 recess

13 July: Deadline for Graham Platner to withdraw from Maine Senate race if Democratic Party wishes to name replacement

14 July: Fed chair Kevin Warsh testifies before the House Financial Services Committee.

15 July: Senate Judiciary Committee confirmation hearing for Attorney General nominee Todd Blanche

15 July: Senate Select Committee on Intelligence confirmation hearing for Director of National Intelligence nominee Jay Clayton

24 July: Section 122 tariffs expire

27 July: Deadline for Maine Democratic Party to name Senate candidate if Platner drops out

4 August: Michigan primary election

3 November: National midterm elections

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Positive: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a positive impact on the macro business environment

Neutral: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a neutral or negligible impact on the macro business environment

Negative: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a negative impact on the macro business environment

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